RESJ Community Partner Services Evaluation Framework

In June of 2020, the Portland Public Schools' (PPS) Office of Internal Performance Audit issued the Contracts Audit – Contract Management of Personal Services Contract.The audit focused on the management of personal service contracts for direct student services. The Racial Equity and Social Justice (RESJ) department manages the majority of contracts that fall into this category and as a result, have been asked to take the lead in the development of the Implementation Plan to address the recommendations included in the audit.

The purpose of the below information is to provide the Audit Committee with an update of progress towards implementation of the following outstanding recommendations.:

- Recommendation 3b - Utilize the Board Cover Memo to create a template for Contract Managers to document the review and evaluation of all contracts.
- Recommendation 3c- Require the review and evaluation be reviewed and approved by the Contract Manager's supervisor and submitted to the Purchasing and Contracting department for record keeping.

This proposal will outline potential shifts in the personnel services evaluation structure for the RESJ Community Partners to be implemented during the 2026-2027 school year.

<u>Current Evaluation Process</u>
Currently, the Community Partner Services Evaluation process consists of four (4) components: (1) Service Provision, (2) Provider Quarterly Reports, (3) Building Leader Feedback, and (4) Partner Impact Assessment. Together, these components provide the RESJ department with critical information about what is working well, what can be improved or strengthened, and if contractual agreements for service provision should continue, discontinue, or be revised.

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Below we outline the current structure with recommendations to continue, discontinue, or modify.

Component	Description	Continue?
Service Provision	Service provision is documented in two ways: (1) partners provide the lists of students and/or families with whom they work each quarter, including total hours of service, and (2) RESJ department staff members hold site visits to observe partners in action as services are provided.	Yes
Quarterly Narrative Reports	Each quarter, in addition to hours of service, each partner interviews students and/or families and provides narrative (qualitative) feedback into the nature and personal impact of their provided services.	Yes
Building Leader Feedback	Building leader feedback is gathered through two primary mechanisms: (1) an annual Community Partner Building Leader Feedback Form, and (2) ad hoc feedback between building leaders and RESJ department staff throughout the school year.	Yes
Partner Impact Assessment	As a part of their contractual scopes of work, partners draft SMART goals aligned with the PPS Theory of Action and District Academic Improvement Plan. Goals are written to impact the following academic areas: attendance, reading and/or mathematics performance, student behavior, and graduation, as appropriate.	Yes*

**Note: Recommendation is to continue impact assessments with modifications*

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Proposed Evaluation Shift

Below is the proposed evaluation framework with recommended modifications to the Partner Impact Assessment section. As noted, the sole shift is in the measures used to assess partner impacts. When reviewing the research-based strategies that partners employ (see Appendix A) and the services that they provide, staff have determined that measures that assess partner impact based on services to students and families should be more aligned to the strategy areas. A description of each proposed evaluation component is included below along with the lingering questions that each component addresses and/or answers.

The RESJ department has begun the process of building the tools and measures necessary to document the annual performance evaluation and will be modifying the contracts review template to ensure all required evaluation components of the annual performance evaluation will be included in the contracts review template.

The RESJ department anticipates the above noted processes and procedures will be fully implemented beginning the 2026-2027 school year, meaning the contracts signed for the 2026/2027 school year (typically in June of each year) will be evaluated with the updated contracts review template. To demonstrate the full implementation of the above noted recommendations, the completed annual performance evaluation of the 2026-2027 contracts will be provided to the Office of Internal Performance Audit for confirmation of implementation by June 15 of 2027. Contracts for the 2027-2028 school year will not be signed by PPS management until this evaluation is completed.

For the current contract cycle (2025-2026 school year), contracts will be evaluated using the current evaluation framework, which consists of the four (4) previously mentioned components: (1) Service Provision, (2) Provider Quarterly Reports, (3) Building Leader Feedback, and (4) Partner Impact Assessment.

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Component	Description	Question(s) Addressed/Answered
Service Provision	Service provision is documented in two ways: (1) partners provide the lists of students and/or families with whom they work each quarter, including total hours of service, and (2) RESJ department staff members hold site visits to observe partners in action as services are provided.	Were services provided as outlined in the scope of work and per the contractual agreement? How many students and/or families were supported? Over how many hours?
Quarterly Narrative Reports	Each quarter, in addition to hours of service, each partner interviews students and/or families and provides narrative (qualitative) feedback into the nature and personal impact of their provided services.	What are students and families verbally reporting as the impact of the support provided by partners?
Building Leader Feedback	Building leader feedback is gathered through two primary mechanisms: (1) an annual Community Partner Building Leader Feedback Form, and (2) ad hoc feedback sessions between building leaders and RESJ department staff throughout the school year.	How satisfied are building leaders with the partners in their schools and the work that the partners perform?
Partner Impact Assessment	As a part of their contractual scopes of work, partners draft annual goals aligned to the strategy(ies) that partners employ to support students. Goals will be written to impact areas such as, but not limited to: students' sense of belonging, students' connection with a trusted adult, family engagement with school, family's ability to advocate for self and student, family's	To what extent has partner support and involvement resulted in increases in the strategy-aligned, identified measures (e.g., engagement, self-determination, self-advocacy, etc.) as reported by students and families?

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Component	Description	Question(s) Addressed/Answered
	school event participation, etc*. Impact areas such as these are more appropriately aligned to the strategies and supports that partners offer.	

* *Note: Aligned measures will be co-designed by the research and evaluation staff with input from partners during the spring.*

Appendix A. PPS Racial Equity Partnership Strategies

Strategy	Definition	Grades
#1 Culturally Specific Family Engagement	Family engagement is designed to reduce or eliminate institutional barriers for families of color to advocate for the needs of their students.	PK-5
#2 Wraparound Services	Provision of culturally specific and culturally responsive services to support student academic and social success. This includes case management, academic tutoring/support, service referral, student groups, and progress monitoring. Wraparound services have a comprehensive approach to meeting the needs of students.	Grade 8 + High School
#3 Leadership Development & Mentoring	Services are designed to provide positive relationship development and support to students to reduce disproportionate discipline rates and increase attendance and a sense of belonging at school for students of color. This includes providing positive and diverse adult relationships that are reflective of students' culture and identity.	Middle School + Grade 9
#4 Extended Learning & Enrichment	Programming provides safe, structured and engaging activities to enhance and expand the learning of students outside of school hours. This includes after school programming and enrichment activities. Enrichment activities provide opportunities for students to pursue learning in their own areas of interest and strengths. Research has shown that students engaged in these activities can lead to increased academic performance and attendance.	Middle School
#5 Positive Cultural Identity Development & Student Advocacy	Programming provides participating youth with exposure and opportunity to engage in activities that empower them to embrace a confident and positive cultural identity while preserving and sharing cultural heritages and traditions amongst their peers. Activities provide opportunities for students to learn and practice new methods of self-expression in a safe and culturally affirming environment.	Middle School